

Inventory & Shipping

The last stops before the customer — keeping counts trustworthy in the warehouse, and getting every box out the door complete and on time.

POST-PRODUCTION

“ The stockroom keeps the trust; the shipping dock keeps the promise.

WHO THEY ARE

The Inventory Manager takes released material and build-to-inventory parts, warehouses them with accurate ProShop locations, and keeps counts trustworthy through cycle counts and ‘quantity verified’ timestamps. The Shipper is the final stop — assembling packing slips, certs of conformance, AS9102s, and material certs into the shipped box, and getting it out via the right carrier.

Together they own traceability and on-time delivery. Alone, each inherits whatever the upstream teams did or didn't finish — which is why Shipping is often the ‘Hail Mary’ department that rarely gets the lead time everyone else had.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

- Put away** Inventory picks up released COTS and BTI parts; assigns warehouse / rack / shelf / bin and updates ProShop.
- Verify** Labels physical material for traceability and ticks **quantity verified**; runs rotating cycle counts.
- Queue** Shipper opens the Shipping dashboard — both final-inspected and outgoing-inspected (OSP) queues.
- Pack** Cycle-counts the physical parts; handles partial shipments, back-orders, or routes extras to inventory.
- Certify** Assembles the cert packet (CFC + AS9102 + material certs) via the ProShop PDF generator.
- Ship** Picks the carrier, prints the packing slip, uploads the full packet to the customer's portal.

SNAPSHOT

Workflow stage	Post-production
Inventory streams	COTS + BTI parts
Trust signal	‘Quantity verified’
Cert formats	AS9102 / LM / default
Delivery counts when	Paperwork clears

ENVIRONMENT & TECH COMFORT

Both roles are on their feet — Inventory at warehouse racks with a scanner, Shipper at a packing station juggling parts, labels, and printed cert packets. Physical, mobile work with a terminal nearby. UI needs to survive interruption: pick it up, put it down, don't lose your place.

Software proficiency	Medium
Manufacturing depth	Medium
Physical / interrupt-driven work	High

IN THEIR WORDS

“Aerospace and medical clients count delivery from the day the paperwork clears — not the day the box lands on their dock.”

WHAT DRIVES THEM — AND WHAT GETS IN THE WAY

The lens Product & Design should hold when building for this user: what they're trying to achieve, where the current experience fails them, and what they need from the product to succeed.

● GOALS

- Keep inventory numbers accurate enough that purchasing can trust them.
- Optimize warehouse layout for both safety and lookup speed.
- Preserve the traceability chain from vendor cert to shelf to shipped box.
- Every box out the door: right parts, right paperwork, right carrier, on time.

● FRUSTRATIONS

- No default 'released, waiting for inventory' dashboard — the team builds a custom query.
- The location field has no history — moving a rack loses the prior location.
- The cert packet still needs print-to-PDF, save, then attach-to-email.
- Shipping absorbs upstream lead-time slippage — always the 'Hail Mary' dept.

● NEEDS FROM PROSHOP

- A first-class 'waiting for inventory' view, not a hand-built query.
- Location history and an overflow / second-location field, not free-text notes.
- One-click cert-packet email straight from the WO, no manual PDF shuffle.
- Standard op numbering surfaced so shippers aren't slowed by inconsistent WOs.

THE NUMBERS THEY'RE MEASURED ON

Inventory turn

How long parts sit before they're pulled.

Accuracy

Cycle-count discrepancy rate — is on-hand trustworthy?

OTD

On-time delivery per customer, verified at ship.

Clean ship

Damaged-shipment and wrong-quantity rate.

PROSHOP MODULES THEY LIVE IN

Inventory & Material Planning **HOME**

Quality Systems & Inspection **HOME**

Sales & Work Orders **READS**

Data Management **READS**

Job Costing & Financial Data **FEEDS**

WHERE THEY SIT IN THE FLOW

UPSTREAM

QA / Inspection

Releases final-inspected parts + cert data

PASSED →

THIS PERSONA

Inventory & Shipping

Warehouses, packs, certifies & ships

SHIPMENT →

DOWNSTREAM

Customer + Accounting

Receive the goods; invoice is generated

Everything upstream converges here: the certs the Receiver uploaded, the WO history Planning built, the CFC flag Order Entry set. If any piece is missing, the customer's dock closes the box and counts 'delivery' as the day the paperwork finally arrives.

Source: ProShop persona sessions + product docs. Cert-packet email was flagged in-session as on the roadmap.

Authored and updated 8/27/2026 by Samantha Jorgenson, Product Operations Manager

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